# Cisplatin every 3 weeks + head and neck radiotherapy

Cisplatin and radiotherapy work together to treat locally advanced head and neck cancer. Your team explains the treatment aim, likely benefit and alternatives for your diagnosis.

**Locally advanced stage III–intravenous (IV) squamous head and neck cancer.** · NCCP 00387 v5 · Document revised 10 November 2026

**Your personal plan:** this is the standard regimen schedule. Your team confirms your prescribed doses, cycles, treatment changes and appointments in your written plan.

Locally advanced stage III–IV squamous head and neck cancer.

## My overall treatment

Cisplatin every 3 weeks × 3 with radiation.

**21** day view

Treatment timing in this window

**Cisplatin** — Day 1

### Cisplatin with radiotherapy

Cisplatin 100 mg/m² on Day 1 every 21 days for three planned cycles during radiotherapy. Cisplatin is given before radiation on the same day. If radiotherapy is cancelled, cisplatin is held until radiation resumes; the team updates both calendars.

### Recovery and follow-up

Mouth, skin, swallowing, energy and hydration may need support after radiation ends. The team arranges response assessment and follows hearing, kidney or nerve problems. Any further chemotherapy is a separate prescription.

## A typical 21-day cycle

| Day 1 | Day 2–21 |
|---|---|
| Cisplatin then radiation | Radiation and support continue |

Timing may change after review. Side effects can occur on any day; there are no guaranteed safe days.

## My tests and checks

| When | What is checked | Timing / reason |
|---|---|---|
| **Before** | **Baseline safety and preparation**<br>NCCP / radiation plan | Blood count, kidneys/liver; hearing/creatinine clearance (CrCl) if indicated. Dental, nutrition and radiation preparation. |
| **During** | **Bloods and symptoms**<br>NCCP | Blood count, kidneys/liver before each cycle. Review hearing, nerves, intake and radiation symptoms. |
| **After / response** | **Follow-up and tests**<br>NCCP / individual plan | Continue recovery, dental and swallowing care; scans and tests individually planned. |

## Between treatments

- Radiation has its own appointment calendar; mouth, skin and swallowing effects may build across weeks.
- Keep drinking and nutrition support active; seek help before intake or weight falls substantially.

Bring your medicine list, test dates, treatment calendar and actual urgent contacts.

**When to get help**

**Call 112** / **999** for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

**Call oncology immediately:** temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

**Oncology daytime:** 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

**EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.**



Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.

# What to watch for

You do not need to know which medicine caused a symptom before calling.

### 1 Hearing / tinnitus

**Cisplatin**

Report ringing in the ears or hearing change before the next dose; effects can be lasting.

### 2 Mouth / throat / saliva

**Head and neck radiotherapy**

Mouth pain, thick saliva, dry mouth or swallowing difficulty can limit drinking; seek help early.

### 3 Blood cells / infection

**Cisplatin**

Fever, shivering, sudden illness, unusual bruising or bleeding needs prompt oncology advice.

### 4 Kidneys / fluids

**Cisplatin**

Much less urine, persistent vomiting or inability to drink needs urgent advice. Drip fluids and blood tests help protect kidneys.

### 5 Nausea / appetite

**Cisplatin**

Take the prescribed prevention and rescue medicines. Call if vomiting persists or fluids will not stay down.

### 6 Nerves / hands / feet

**Cisplatin**

Report numbness, tingling, balance problems or difficulty with fine tasks; symptoms can persist.

### 7 Skin / treated area

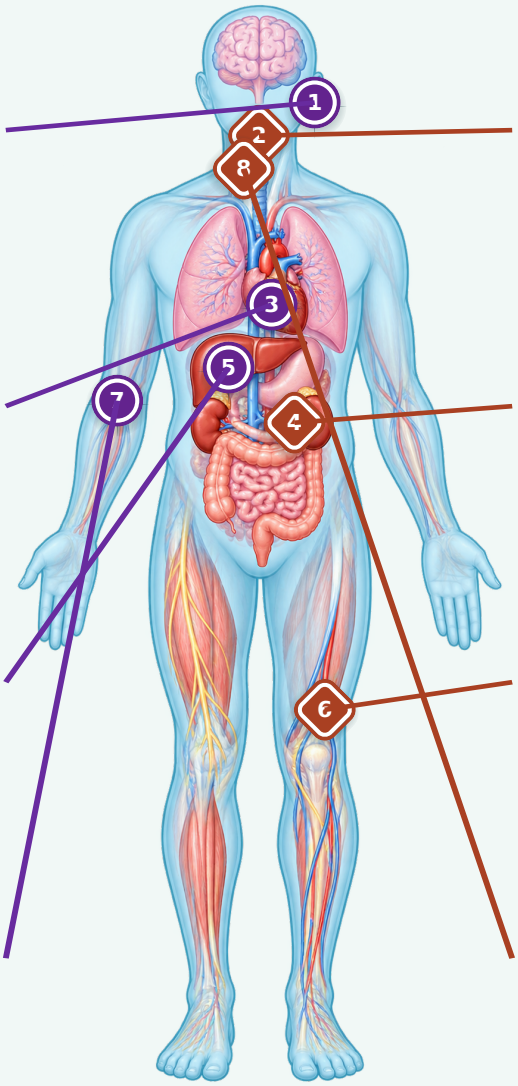
**Radiotherapy**

Follow the radiation team’s skin plan. Report painful redness, peeling or a wound that is not healing.

### 8 Teeth / jaw / swallowing

**Head and neck radiotherapy**

Dental review, nutrition and swallowing support continue through recovery. Report jaw stiffness, weight loss or choking.




Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Contact oncology promptly for fever, sudden illness, persistent vomiting, much less urine, severe mouth pain or inability to drink. Report hearing change, ringing in the ears or new numbness before the next dose. Severe breathing difficulty, chest pain or collapse is an emergency.

**When to get help**

**Call 112 / 999** for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

**Call oncology immediately:** temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital’s temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

**Oncology daytime:** 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

**EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.**


Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.

# Keep your treatment details to hand

**Locally advanced stage III–IV squamous head and neck cancer.** · NCCP 00387 v5 · Document revised 10 November 2026

Print this page **one-sided on A4 at Actual size / 100%**. Cut only the dashed outer border around both panels. **Do not cut the centre line.** Fold with FRONT and BACK facing out, then glue or tape the blank backs together. Finished size: **85.6 × 54 mm**. Keep the stamp side writable.

**FRONT / CONTACTS**

## My Treatment Card

SACTCheck

Name: _____

**Cisplatin + radiotherapy (RT)**

Cisplatin every 3 weeks × 3 with radiation.

Phase: _____ Planned cycles: 3

**Daytime (EXAMPLE)** 087 12345678

**Out of hours (EXAMPLE)** 087 87654321

**Unwell or fever? Call oncology now.**
Severe breathing difficulty, chest pain or collapse: **112 / 999.**

EXAMPLE NUMBERS — replace before patient use.

**BACK / TREATMENT RECORD**

## My cycle record

Team stamps after each completed cycle.

| C1 | C2 | C3 | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Date / initials | Date / initials | Date / initials | My treatment information |

Plan changed? Ask the team to update this card.

CUT outer border

**FOLD centre — do not cut**

## Keep the record accurate

The team dates and initials each recorded treatment unit when complete. A cycle is complete after its final planned dose; a weekly-treatment stamp records that weekly dose. Delays, omitted doses or a changed plan need a note or a replacement card. A stamp does not approve the next treatment. Keep any medicine-specific alert card too.

## Put your treatment page on your phone

Scan your QR and check the treatment name. Save that page to your home screen.

### iPhone / Safari

Tap Share → Add to Home Screen. Select Open as Web App if offered, then Add.

### Android / Chrome

Tap the three-dot menu → Add to Home screen or Install and create shortcut. Choose the shortcut option and confirm.

Menu wording varies. The QR opens information, not a personal record. Paper stamps do not update the website. Check that the saved icon opens the correct treatment.

## Your local contacts and resources

**Oncology daytime:** 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

**EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.**

Hospital / team: _____

Backup if the team cannot be reached: _____

Additional local services and resources will be added when confirmed. Your team must check and complete this page before patient use.



Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.